

40. Which of the following states ranks first in India in length of roads?

- (a) Maharashtra (b) Uttar Pradesh
(c) Madhya Pradesh (d) Rajasthan

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

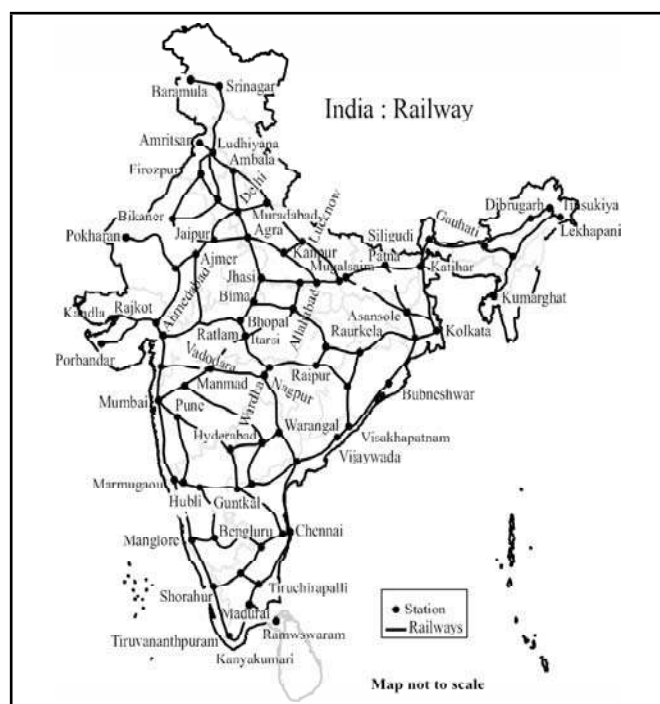
Ans. (a)

Among the given states, Maharashtra ranks first in India in terms of the length of roads.

ii. Rail Transport

*The first railway on the Indian subcontinent ran over a stretch of 34km from Bombay (Mumbai) to Thane on 16th April, 1853.

*The rail network was started between Kolkata and Raniganj (39km) in 1854 AD, and between, Chennai (Madras) and Arkonam (101 km) in 1856. In India, until 1871, the presidency towns of Kolkata, Mumbai and Chennai were connected by the railways. On the basis of width, the Indian Railways routes are divided into three parts.



- (i) **Meter Gauge**- The distance between the two tracks is 1 meter or 1000 mm.
(ii) **Broad Gauge** - The distance between the tracks is 1.676 m or 1676 mm or 5 ½ feet.
(iii) **Narrow Gauge**- The distance between the two tracks is 762 mm or 610 mm.

*The longest railway route in India is in the state of Uttar Pradesh. *According to the Indian Railway Yearbook, 2023-

24 the total length of the rail route in the country is **69181** km. during 2023-24. The length of Meter Gauge is **1159** km, the length of Broad Gauge is **66820** km and the length of Narrow Gauge is **1202** km. *Due to flat topography, low slope, high agricultural productivity and high population density in the Gangetic plain, the highest concentration of rail circuits is seen. The entire rail circuit is divided into 17 railway zones. *The headquarters of the North Central Railway zone is located in Prayagraj. The North Central Railway zone was established on April 1, 2003.

*Indian Railways is one of the world's largest rail networks with 69181 route kilometers of route lengths as of 31.03.2024. Out of 69181 RKMs., BG constitutes 66820 RKMs. (96.59%), MG 1159 RKMs. (1.67%) and NG 1202 RKMs. (1.74%). The growth of its route length, running and track kilometers. since independence is as follows-

Year	Route Kms.	Running Track Kms.	Total Track Kms.
1950-51	53596	59315	77609
1960-61	56247	63602	83706
1970-71	59790	71669	98546
1980-81	61240	75860	104480
1990-91	62367	78607	108858
2000-01	63028	81865	108706
2010-11	64173	87114	114037
2020-21	68103	100866	126611
2021-22	68043	102831	128305
2022-23	68584	106493	132310
2023-24	69181	109748	135207

Zone/ Headquarters	Route Kms.	Running Track Kms.	Total Track Kms.
Central, Mumbai	4275	7435	9716
Eastern, Kolkata	2841	6067	7698
East Central, Hajipur	4377	7048	9332
East Coast, Bhubaneswar	3071	5609	6987
Northern, New Delhi	7406	10702	13957
North Central, Prayagraj	3522	5774	7089
North Eastern, Gorakhpur	3492	5373	5581
Northeast Frontier, Maligaon (Guwahati)	4348	5269	7053
North Western, Jaipur	5712	8131	8561

Southern, Chennai	5092	7761	9505
South Central, Secunderabad	6610	10227	12310
South Eastern, Kolkata	2749	5679	6573
South East Central, Bilaspur	2541	4410	5598
South Western, Hubli	3692	5517	6620
Western, Mumbai	6284	8840	11101
West Central, Jabalpur	3124	5817	7394
Metro Railway, Kolkata	45	89	132
Total	69181	109748	135207

*The headquarters of Northern Railway and West-Central railway zone are located in **New Delhi** and **Jabalpur**, respectively. *The headquarter of **North-Western Railway** is in **Jaipur**. Headquarter of **South-Eastern Railway** is located in Kolkata while the headquarters of **East Coast Railway** is located in **Bhubaneswar**.

*The **East Central Railway** is headquartered at Hajipur (Bihar).

*Other major rail zones and their headquarters are as follows- Southern Railway - Chennai, Central Railway - Mumbai, Western Railway - Mumbai (Churchgate), North-Eastern Railway - Gorakhpur, Eastern Railway - Kolkata, North-East Frontier Railway - Maligaon (Guwahati), South-Central Railway-Secunderabad, South-East Central Railway-Bilaspur, etc.

*On 29th December 2010, Metro Railway Kolkata became the 17th zone of the Indian Railways, operated by the Ministry of Railways.

*In India the Rail Coach Factory is located in **Kapurthala**. In India, the electric engine is manufactured at Chittaranjan locomotive works, a plant that was established at the Chittaranjan (West Bengal and Jharkhand) border in 1950.

*In India the factory to manufacture diesel and electric engines was established at **Banaras Locomotive Works** in Varanasi in the year 1961.

*The steam engine was manufactured by the Tata Engineering and Locomotive Company Ltd. in Jamshedpur. *The National Academy of Indian Railways is located in Baroda (Vadodara).

*The **Fairy Queen train** consists of the world's oldest engine. This engine was built in 1855 and was re-launched by Indian Railways in 1997. In India, the third rail coach factory

is being set up in **Rae Bareilly** (Uttar Pradesh).

*Sal or Sakhu's wood is very hard, heavy, strong and brown in color. It is used in the construction of railway sleepers.

*Konkan Rail link between Mumbai (Roha) and Mangaluru (Thokur). *India's first CNG train was started in January 2015 on the **Rewari-Rohtak** section.

The operation of CNG trains in India will be helpful in reducing greenhouse gas emissions and reduction in diesel consumption. For the operation of CNG train, the railway has modified a 1400 horsepower engine into dual fuel using fumigation technology. i.e., *These trains run on both CNG and diesel. *On 14th July 2015 Railway Minister Suresh Prabhu launched the Gandhidham-Tuna Tekra rail line in Gujarat through remote control from New Delhi. This is India's first railway track based on the P.P.P. model. The total length of this track is approximately 17 km. It will provide service to Tuna Port and Tekra's dry bulk terminal.

In India, several railway lines have been built in the mountainous regions which are collectively known as the Mountain Railway of India. Darjeeling Himalayan railway, Nilgiri Mountain railway, Kalka-Shimla Railway and Matheran Hill Railways fall under this category. Siliguri and Darjeeling railway stations are part of the Darjeeling Himalayan Railway. It was recognized by UNESCO as a World Heritage Site in 1999.

*Rail services in India's northeastern states of Tripura and Mizoram have been fully initiated. In February 2013, the then Railway Minister Pawan Kumar Bansal inaugurated the first railway line in Arunachal Pradesh (Harmuti - Naharlagun).

*In November 2014, Meghalaya was added to the country's rail map, when PM Narendra Modi flagged off the first train from Mendipathar (Meghalaya) to Guwahati.

***Pirpanjal Railway Tunnel** is located in Jammu and Kashmir (U.T.). Its length is 11.2 km. ***Karbude Railway Tunnel** is located in Ratnagiri district of Maharashtra. ***Natuwadik Rail Tunnel** is located in the state of Maharashtra. ***Tike Rail Tunnel** is located in Maharashtra. **Savarda Rail Tunnel** is located in Maharashtra.

*In December 2004, the then Prime Minister of India, Manmohan Singh approved a plan to run a bullet train between Mumbai and Ahmedabad. There was an agreement with

Japan in this regard. *On September 14, 2017, Japan's Prime Minister Shinzo Abe and Prime Minister Narendra Modi laid the foundation of the nation's first fast moving railway project (Bullet train project). This bullet train connects the country's financial capital Mumbai to Ahmedabad. Its total length is 508 km. *The National High-Speed Rail Corporation Limited (NHRCL) has been established to start the implementation of this project. The bullet train's maximum operating speed on this route is 320 km per hour.

1. The railways in India were first opened in –

- (a) 1853 (b) 1854
(c) 1855 (d) 1859

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (a)

In the tenure of Lord Dalhousie, the country's first railway was built by the Great Indian Peninsula Railway (GIPR), opened on 16 April, 1853 between Bombay and Thane.

2. When was the first railway line opened in India and between which stations?

- (a) Between Delhi-Agra in 1854
(b) Between Bombay and Pune in 1853
(c) Between Bombay and Thane in 1853
(d) None of these

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

3. The first railway line in India was started in the year –

- (a) 1856 (b) 1853
(c) 1856 (d) 1855

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. The width between two rails of Broad gauge is –

- (a) $6 \frac{1}{2}$ ft (b) $5 \frac{1}{2}$ ft
(c) 5 ft (d) $4 \frac{1}{2}$ ft

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (b)

Indian Railways uses three types of gauges :

- (1) Meter gauge - The distance between two bars is 1 metre or 1000 mm.
(2) Broad gauge - The distance between two bars is 1.676 metres or 1676 mm.
(3) Narrow gauge - The distance between the two tracks is 762 mm or 610 mm.

5. The shortest rail route of Mumbai from Gorakhpur runs through –

- (a) Agra (b) Allahabad
(c) Jhansi (d) Delhi

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (b)

After observing Indian railway map, it is clear that the shortest rail route of Mumbai from Gorakhpur runs through Allahabad (Prayagraj).

6. The Rail Ministry of India has the plan to introduce Bullet train between :

- (a) Mumbai - Ahmedabad
(b) Mumbai - Hyderabad
(c) Mumbai - New Delhi
(d) Mumbai - Pune

U.P.U.D.A. / L.D.A. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (a)

Former Indian Prime Minister Manmohan Singh approved the plan to introduce a Bullet train between Mumbai & Ahmedabad in December 2004.

7. Which one of the following pairs is not correctly matched?

Railway Zone	Headquarters
(a) North-Eastern Railway :	Gorakhpur
(b) South-Eastern Railway :	Bhubaneswar
(c) Eastern Railway :	Kolkata
(d) South-East Central Railway :	Bilaspur

I.A.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (b)

The headquarters of South-Eastern Railway is located in Kolkata while the headquarters of Eastern Coastal Railway is located in Bhubaneswar. Thus, option (b) is not correctly matched.

8. Which of the following is not the correct match?

- (a) Central Railway - Mumbai
(b) Western Railway - Churchgate

- (c) North Frontier Railway - Prayagraj
(d) South Eastern Railway - Garden Reach, Kolkata

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

The correct match is :

Central Railway	- Mumbai
Western Railway	- Churchgate
North East Frontier Railway	- Maligaon (Guwahati)
South Eastern Railway	- Garden Reach, Kolkata
North Central Railway	- Prayagraj

9. The headquarters of South-Eastern Railway is –

- (a) Nagpur (b) Bilaspur
(c) Hyderabad (d) Kolkata

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

10. Consider the following statements concerning the Indian Railways:

- The headquarters of the North Western Railway are located at Jodhpur.**
- 'Indrail pass' - a travel - as- you- please ticket has been created especially for freedom fighters and sportspersons who have represented India in any game/sport.**
- Fairy Queen is a train using the world's oldest working engines and the Indian Railways conducts a journey of wildlife and heritage sites on it.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 2 only (b) 3 only
(c) 1 and 2 (d) None

I.A.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

The headquarters of the North-Western Railway is located in Jaipur, not in Jodhpur. Hence, statement (1) is not correct. 'Indrail pass' does not only provide excellent value for money but also enhances the charm of holidays for foreign tourists. It offers foreign tourists NRI's the opportunity to travel as they like, over the entire railway network without any route restrictions within the period of validity of the Indrail pass. Hence, statement (2) is also incorrect. The Fairy Queen is the oldest working steam locomotive in the world, built in 1855. It was completely overhauled in 1996 and resumed commercial operations in 1997. Hence statement (3) is correct. Therefore, option (b) is correct.

11. The Railway Zone Headquarters Hajipur is located in –

- (a) Chhattisgarh (b) Uttar Pradesh
(c) Jharkhand (d) Bihar

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

Currently, Indian Railway has been divided among 17 zones (Headquarters). Among these headquarters of Indian Railways in Bihar, only the East Central Railway is located at Hajipur. Hajipur Headquarters started functioning on 1st October, 2002.

12. Where is the Headquarters of North-Central Railway Zone situated?

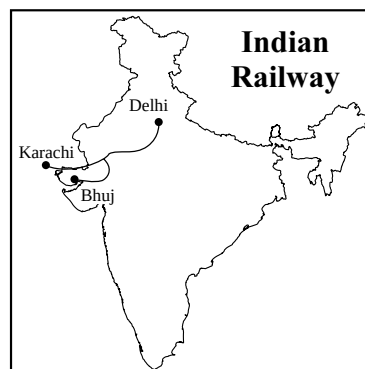
- (a) Allahabad (b) Jabalpur
(c) Bhopal (d) Delhi

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (a)

The headquarters of the North Central Railway is situated in Prayagraj (Allahabad). The North Central Railway, in its present form, came into existence on 1 April, 2003. The headquarters of the North Railway Zone is located in New Delhi while the headquarters of the West Central Railway Zone is situated in Jabalpur.

13. Consider the map given below: Two tourists traveling from Delhi, one to Karachi and the other to Bhuj wanted to have company. The railway junction up to which they can travel together as shown in the map is –



- (a) Phulera (b) Jodhpur
(c) Luni (d) Balotra

I.A.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (d)

The first rail route goes from Balotra to Munabao via Badmer and second rail route goes south until Bhuj.

14. Even though the Railways are the most pervasive mode of transport in India, it is road transport that received the maximum impetus in most of the post-independence period. Which of the following are the reasons for this?

1. Railways are cheap to operate but the associated capital costs are very high.
2. Given the geographic spread of human settlements, it is unrealistic that the railways alone can serve the needs of transport.
3. The per unit (tonne/km) cost of transport is cheaper on the road compared to rail transport.
4. Given the indivisible nature of the Railways, it is not always convenient for the population to avail themselves of it with the same ease as private cars, buses or two-wheelers.

Select the correct answer by using the codes given below:

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 1, 2 and 4
(c) 1, 3 and 4 (d) 2, 3 and 4

I.A.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

The per unit (tonne/km) cost of transport is not cheaper on the road compared to rail transport. Hence, statement 3 is incorrect. Other statements are true.

15. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the codes given below :

List- I	List- II
A. Rail Coach Factory	1. Bangalore
B. Wheel and Axle Plant	2. Perambur
C. Diesel Locomotive Works	3. Kapurthala
D. Integral Coach Factory	4. Varanasi

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	2	3	4
(b)	4	3	2	1
(c)	1	3	4	2
(d)	3	1	4	2

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008

Ans. (d)

The correct match of lists mentioned in the question is as follows:

Rail Coach Factory	–	Kapurthala
Wheel and Axle Plant	–	Bangalore
Diesel Locomotive Works (New - Banaras Locomotive Works)	–	Varanasi
Integral Coach Factory	–	Perambur

16. The Diesel Rail Locomotive is manufactured at –

- (a) Chittaranjan (b) Manduadih
(c) Jamshedpur (d) Perambur

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

Chittaranjan Locomotive Works – Electric locomotive (Chittaranjan)
Banaras Locomotive Works (Formerly Diesel Locomotive Works) – Diesel Electric locomotive,
Tata Engineering and Locomotive Company Ltd. (Jamshedpur) - Steam Locomotive
Integral Coach Factory (Perambur, Chennai) - Rail Coaches.
Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.

17. Which of the following groups of states where passenger rail coaches are manufactured widely?

- (a) Punjab & Tamil Nadu
(b) Odisha & West Bengal
(c) Tamil Nadu & West Bengal
(d) West Bengal & Punjab

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

In given the options, Kapurthala in Punjab and Perambur in Tamil Nadu are the states, where passenger rail coaches are manufactured widely.

18. Where is the Railway Staff College located?

- (a) Madras (b) Vadodara
(c) Allahabad (d) Hyderabad

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (b)

The National Academy of Indian Railways formerly Railway Staff College, is a centralized training institute for Group A and Group B officers of Indian Railways. It is located in Vadodara.

19. In which industry is Sal Wood used mostly?

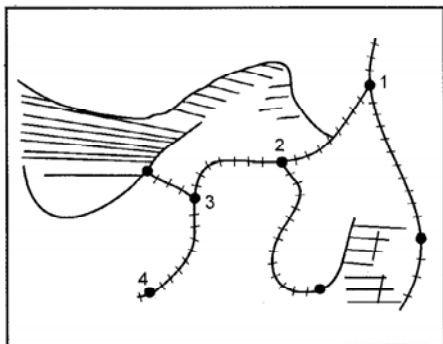
- (a) Paper (b) Matches
(c) Kaththa (d) Railway Sleepers

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (d)

The wood of the sal tree is very hard, heavy, strong and brown colored. The wood does not get affected by termites for a long period of time, that is why it is used in the making of railway sleepers and railway coaches etc.

20. The fourth railway junctions shown by numerals 1, 2, 3 and 4 on the rough outline map of Gujarat are respectively.



- (a) Palanpur, Mahesana, Ahmedabad and Vadodara
(b) Mahesana, Surendranagar, Rajkot and Junagarh
(c) Palanpur, Kanda, Bhuj, and Okla
(d) Ahmedabad, Vadodara, Bhavnagar and Bharuch

I.A.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

The railway junctions shown in the map are (1) Mahesana, (2) Surendranagar, (3) Rajkot and (4) Junagarh.

21. The third rail coach factory is being established at

- (a) Amethi (b) Raibareli
(c) Champaran (d) Kapurthala

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 1995

Ans. (b)

The third Rail Coach Factory is being established at Raibareli in India. The foundation stone was laid in 2007 and construction work started in 2009.

22. On which rail section was the first CNG train launched?

- (a) Delhi – Agra section
(b) Rohtak – Chandigarh section
(c) Delhi – Chandigarh section
(d) Rewari – Rohtak section

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (d)

The first CNG train was launched on the Rewari-Rohtak section of the Northern Zone. It is based on the dual fuel system— diesel and CNG. The introduction of the CNG train will reduce greenhouse gas emission and also the consumption of diesel.

23. Which of the following states became the first state where the railway track was made on the PPP model?

- (a) Kerala (b) Gujarat
(c) Karnataka (d) Maharashtra

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (b)

Gujarat is the first state where the railway track was made on PPP (Public-Private Partnership) model. The Gandhidham and Tuna-Tekra rail line, built under the PPP model, was commissioned on 14 July, 2015. It was built by Deendayal Port Authority.

24. Which one of the following statements is not true of the Konkan Railway?

- (a) The total length is about 760 km.
(b) It runs through the states of Karnataka, Goa, Maharashtra and Kerala
(c) It is the only rail route that cuts across the Western Ghats
(d) The Konkan Railway Construction Company which came into being raised money through public issues.

I.A.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (b)

The Konkan Railway begins from Roha station in Maharashtra and ends at Mangalore, Karnataka. It connects the states of Maharashtra, Goa and Karnataka. This rail does not run to Kerala but provides an easy gateway movement from Kerala to Maharashtra, Karnataka and Goa, which is beneficial for Kerala in all aspects. Other statements are correct.

25. The Konkan Railway connects:

- (a) Mumbai to Manmad (b) Roha to Mangalore
(c) Mangalore to Kochi (d) Mumbai to Pune

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

26. Which one of the following sets of states benefits the most from the Konkan Railway?

- (a) Goa, Karnataka, Maharashtra
(b) Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu
(c) Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Goa, Maharashtra
(d) Gujarat, Maharashtra, Goa, Tamil Nadu

I.A.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.